

HOW TO MAKE RUBBER BAND PLANETS

For your model of the solar system, you'll need a lot of rubber bands in various colors, but you can buy big bagfuls quite cheaply. You make the planets in order of their distance from the sun, which will help you to remember their names and where they are in space. The models are not truly to scale, but they do give you a good idea of the sizes of the real planets compared to each other.

WHAT YOU NEED



Flashlight



Yellow rubber bands



Green rubber bands



Red rubber bands



Blue rubber bands



White rubber bands



Yellow cardstock or paper

Scissors

40 pieces of letter-sized paper



Time
90 minutes



Difficulty
Medium

Make the paper ball as round as you can and scrunch it tightly.



1 The center of each planet is a tight ball of scrunched up paper. For the smaller planets, you'll use one piece of paper, or part of one piece. For the bigger planets, you'll scrunch up one piece of paper, then wrap more pieces around it.



2 For Mercury, make the paper ball with just one-quarter of a sheet of paper. Stretch white rubber bands firmly round the ball. Go on adding bands at different angles until you've hidden the paper.